



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Kepler Education
School Website: <https://kepler.education/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Kepler Education (Moscow, ID, 83843) presents a robust classical Christian education platform that centers on the liberal arts, Great Books, and a faith-informed context. Public materials emphasize the Great Conversation, the Great Books tradition, and the integration of theology with learning, with explicit statements of faith and a vocation-like teacher-student partnership. The platform also markets a Diploma Track and college-preparatory elements, signaling some alignment with workforce and college-readiness aims. Taken together, these signals place the school primarily in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL band, with standout strengths in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, Faculty, and Parents & Community, and more pronounced contemporary or workforce-oriented accents in Curriculum and Pedagogy in certain materials. The aggregate posture is therefore SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Key overarching observations: - Strong affirmation of truth, goodness, beauty, and theological grounding; explicit statements of faith and a framed Christian worldview permeate teacher bios, courses, and policies. This aligns with core classical aims around transcendental moral realism and theological grounding. - Curriculum and pedagogy frequently reference liberal arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, and preceptorial-based seminar/workshop formats, with explicit references to classical methods and the Paideia/Great Tradition lineage in many materials. This supports classical rationales, though some sections also highlight diploma pathways and dual enrollment that nod to college preparation. - Parent involvement and community-building are foregrounded (parents as co-educators, Kepler Life, community clubs, conferences), which aligns with the classical emphasis on partnership with families and a living curriculum.

Executive summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot - Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL - Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 4: School Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL - Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

What would move the needle - For Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): More explicit articulation that formation (virtue, wisdom, telos) is the primary aim in practice, not primarily college/work preparation. Emphasize formation of character and happiness as the central outcome, with college/career readiness positioned as a later or parallel pathway rather than the central goal. - For Element 3 (Curriculum): Add explicit public-facing language that details the grammar–logic–rhetoric (trivium) framework within the curriculum, and demonstrate how Great Books are integrated with a well-defined progression through the liberal arts in K–12, not solely in the upper grades. - For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Increase clarity on how contemplative Stré Seminars, scholé-style pauses, and memory-work recitations are implemented across grade bands, with more explicit examples of ritually integrated, contemplative practices beyond occasional singing/chanting. - For Element 5 (Faculty): Provide a transparent, published living-curriculum portrait of the teacher as virtue-model, including ongoing professional formation tied to classical pedagogy and public-facing testimonials of exemplary teaching. - For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand accessible, ongoing parent-formation offerings

(reading groups, book studies) and more frequent, visible opportunities for parents to visit and engage with classrooms or classical events on campus.

Evidence and analysis are drawn from Kepler Education public materials and the Classical/Education lexicon of the Six Essential Elements documents.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes a theologically infused education and explicit faith statements, including Mere Christian alignment and Nicene Creed-level declarations in teacher profiles and policy statements. - Public narratives articulate truth, goodness, and beauty as guiding transcendentals in learning, including direct references to biblical framing and Christian formation in teaching philosophy. For example: “truth, goodness, and beauty” are invoked as guiding ideals and a central aim of pedagogy. - Foundational terms appear repeatedly in bios and mission language (e.g., “Christian faith,” “classical pedagogy,” and commitment to the liberal-arts tradition).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; creedal faith; imago Dei; Logos; wisdom; liturgical framing (where present); reverence and wonder. - Negative keywords: Minimal explicit signaling of relativism or secular humanism in site materials; no clear signals of “morally neutral” or “values clarification.” Overall, negative indicators are not predominant.

Why this rating - The combination of explicit theological framing, statements of faith, and emphasis on transcendentals and sacred orientation aligns squarely with CLASSICAL expectations for religious/metaphysical grounding. The presence of the Nicene Creed-type articulations and explicit faith language signals “Grounded in Theology” and “Liturgical/Communal Practices” elements as well, though liturgical practices are less overt in daily classroom statements; the dominant signal is theological grounding and the transcendentals. This category is clearly CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and obedience to a higher (divine) telos, with the Great Books and liberal arts framed as pathways to human flourishing and wisdom. Example: emphasis on formation through truth, goodness, and beauty and a classical mission; explicit phrasing around Great Books and a “Great Conversation.” - There are explicit references to formation and virtue in teacher narratives, including statements about fostering wonder and directing affections toward higher goods. - However, the platform also markets Diploma Tracks and college-prep resources (e.g., dual enrollment, college prep) that align with workforce or college-readiness aims, signaling some alignment with 21st-century and career-oriented education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation; cultivation of virtue; human flourishing; wisdom; telos; liberal education; Great Books/Great Conversation; truth/goodness/beauty; wisdom. - Negative keywords observed: college-ready/workforce-prep framing is present in the broader marketing (diploma-track/dual enrollment) with mixed signals about the primary aim. The site does not strongly emphasize “21st century skills” in a heavy-handed way, but workforce readiness signals exist via college prep and Diploma Track.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation, virtue, and the transcendentals, which are core classical aims. Yet the explicit marketing of Diploma Tracks, college preparation, and dual-enrollment resources introduces a notable emphasis on college/workforce outcomes that drags the category toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL. The presence of both formation-oriented language and college-prep pathways yields the intermediate ranking.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials emphasize liberal arts, Great Books, and the Great Conversation as central curricular anchors. The platform presents classical education as integrating Western tradition through Great Books and the liberal arts. - There are explicit references to the Great Books and a liberal-arts framework (e.g., “The Great Books and Liberal Arts,” “Diploma Track,” “Paideia pedagogy” in teacher-certification contexts). - There is less explicit, consistent public-facing phrasing about the formal Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as the structural spine of the curriculum, though the Paideia/Great Conversation and liberal-arts framing are present. The site emphasizes a marketplace of classical courses and a diploma path rather than a clearly spelled-out grammar–logic–rhetoric progression across K–12.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: liberal arts; Great Books; Great Conversation; classical education; Paideia pedagogy; curriculum integration with classical tradition. - Negative keywords observed: social-studies-centric framing; overreliance on project-based learning signals (not strongly evident in Kepler’s materials, but listed in general lexicon as a potential negative in some classical-lexicon analyses). The site does not emphasize “social studies” as curriculum replacement; rather, it foregrounds classical texts and liberal arts.

Why this rating - The presence of Great Books-and-liberal-arts orientation and Great Conversation positioning supports CLASSICAL leanings. However, explicit, consistent articulation of the exact Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as the curricular spine (and a guaranteed history-intensive curriculum across all grades) is not consistently foregrounded in the public statements. The combination of strong Great Books/-Great Conversation language with a college-prep pathway places the school in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical signals include Socratic discussion and seminars in older student contexts, as well as contemplative or restorative elements (Scholé-type pacing) and memory work (recitation, chant). The site includes explicit mentions of Socratic dialogue and Paideia-style approaches, with seminars and public speaking emphasis. - There are references to lower-school practices such as singing and chanting and a memory-focused pedagogy, and upper-school opportunities for rhetoric and public speaking. The presence of “preceptorials” and structured dialogue aligns with a classical pedagogy model. - Public materials describe a mix: contemplative/restful elements alongside more rigorous Socratic/seminar-based methods, with upper-grade rhetoric and oratory opportunities described.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Socratic dialogue, seminars, Paideia seminar, rhetoric, speeches, recitation, chanting, memory work, scholé, contemplative learning, wonder-based education. - Negative keywords observed: Some materials suggest episodic or “exposure” to experiential learning in some contexts, which the lexicon marks as a potential negative if it overly supersedes traditional classical approaches. The Kepler materials do not foreground project-based-only pedagogy, but the presence of diploma-based and course-based formats could signal blended approaches.

Why this rating - The pedagogy signals align with classical methods (Socratic dialogue, rhetoric training, memory work, recitation, and learned public speaking) but are juxtaposed with a modern delivery (online courses, diploma tracks, and adult micro-courses). The resulting mix yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL; there are strong classical elements, but the presence of diploma pathways and online marketplaces introduces non-classical framing in some materials.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site strongly positions its faculty as “Passionate, Experienced Teachers at Every Level,” with explicit emphasis on vetted, world-class classical educators who model virtue. The living-curriculum and teacher portraits are highlighted in multiple materials. - Faculty are presented as part of a “living curriculum” and a community of teachers who collaborate and mentor students, which matches classical expectations for mentorship and exemplary role models. The site showcases staff bios and a staff-led culture of classical

education. - The materials emphasize teacher qualification standards, preceptorials, and a close alignment of teachers with classical pedagogy and a traditional faith framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: virtuous educators; character formation; mentorship; living curriculum; portrait of teacher/students; master-apprentice-like collaboration; faculty seminars; professional fellowship. - Negative keywords observed: avoid “facilitator-on-the-side” or “certification-driven jargon without classical context” signals; the available materials emphasize classical formation rather than non-classical, which reduces negative signals in this category.

Why this rating - The materials consistently frame faculty as models of virtue and living curriculum, with strong emphasis on mentorship and classical formation. This aligns very well with CLASSICAL expectations for Faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials explicitly promote a partnership with families and describe parents as co-teachers and primary educators in alliance with the school. This classical-community orientation is reinforced by communications about parent formation and opportunities for parent involvement. - There are clear signals of parental involvement through Kepler Life, clubs, volunteering concepts, and family-centered language; materials discuss parent formation via website content, book studies, and gatherings. - The platform emphasizes an open campus philosophy and welcoming parents to visits and involvement in the learning ecosystem, consistent with classical community-building.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental engagement; home-family collaboration; parent formation; classically-informed parent studies; open campus; parental leadership; community of learners. - Negative keywords observed: none prominent; there is no strong consumer/customer-centric framing that would signal a move away from community partnership.

Why this rating - The school strongly foregrounds parent collaboration, parental formation, and open engagement with families, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal): Sharpen public messaging to foreground formation as the primary educational outcome, with college/dual-enrollment as a complement rather than the central objective. Use explicit language about virtue, wisdom, and telos as the core aims of the educational enterprise.
- For Element 3 (Curriculum): Articulate a more explicit, public framework showing how grammar, logic, and rhetoric are woven into the daily K–12 curriculum, not only in high school or in elective contexts. Provide a visible cross-grade map linking Great Books with a formal Seven Liberal Arts progression.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Add structured exemplars of Scholastic-style rest and memory work across grade bands, with concrete classroom routines and rubrics showing the role of contemplative time, chant/memory, and disciplined dialogue.
- For Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a formal “Portrait of the Teacher” document and a living-curriculum document that ties teacher development to classical pedagogy outcomes, with examples of teacher mentorship models and faculty collaboration.
- For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand and publish a calendar of parent-education events, reading groups, and on-campus opportunities; maintain a clear, public-facing portal showing parent involvement in student formation, not just as customers.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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